Setting Up LinkedIn

Introduction

This document will go over the nitty-gritty of LinkedIn as a platform.

Profile Creation

Firstly, you must create a profile by logging into their official website. Wherein at the top-right corner of their homepage, you will see a button as "join now". Click on it and further follow the instructions given on the screen. You can also use LinkedIn on your mobile with almost the same process.

Profile Optimization

In order to rank your profile on search results, you will need to 100% complete your profile with every profile section completed. Optimizing each section of your LinkedIn profile is important for presenting yourself effectively and achieving your purpose on the platform. Here are some tips and tricks for optimizing each section based on different purposes.

Choosing A Username

Unlike other social networking platforms, LinkedIn prefers you to keep your profile professional which is why you must stick with your original full name while choosing a username here.

Your username will be a part of your LinkedIn profile URL, and it's important to make a good impression on potential employers, clients, and connections.

Here are some tips that come in handy while choosing your username:

- Keep it professional – your username should reflect your professionalism so avoid using nicknames, random numbers, or anything that might be considered unprofessional.
- Use your real name – Whenever possible, use your real name or a version of it. You don't want to be discovered by your potential network as someone who's named after their pet.

- Keep it short – Keep your username simple, short, and easy to remember. A concise username is easier to share and communicate with others.
- Avoid special characters and spaces – Special characters or spaces can make
- your username harder to remember or share. Stick to letters and numbers only.

Uploading A Profile Picture

Your profile picture plays a very important role on Linkedin. Two things come into play when choosing the right picture for your profile – it should be professional and appropriate.

Do's for selecting the profile picture

- Choose a high-quality photo that portrays you in a professional and approachable manner.
- Make sure your face is clear and visible. Avoid using photos with excessive shadows, heavy filters, or low resolution.
- Wear attire that is appropriate for your industry or profession. Business casual or formal wear is typically a safe choice.
- A genuine smile can make you appear friendly and approachable. It creates a positive first impression.
- Your profile picture should focus on your face and shoulders. Avoid using group photos or images with distracting backgrounds.
- Ensure your profile picture is recent and represents how you currently look. You want to avoid surprises for those you connect with in real life

Don'ts for selecting the profile picture

- Avoid selfies as they can appear unprofessional and less polished.
- Avoid using pictures taken at parties, vacations, or casual gatherings.
- Avoid using photos with clothing that may be considered too casual, revealing, or inappropriate for a professional setting.
- Your LinkedIn profile picture should be about you, not a group of people. Using group photos can be confusing for those trying to connect with you.
- Overly filtered photos can be misleading and may not represent your true appearance.
- Animated images or avatars are not suitable for a professional networking platform like LinkedIn.

Headlines



- Optimizing your LinkedIn headline with respect to the algorithm refers to creating a headline that is more likely to be recognized and prioritized by
- LinkedIn's search and recommendation systems.
- Make your headline 'algorithm-friendly' so that it gets more visibility and reaches a wider audience on the platform.
- Your LinkedIn headline sits just below your profile image and name. It is an important part of your brand.

Keywords

- A keyword is a word or phrase that searchers enter into a search engine.
- For LinkedIn, you can create a list of 7–10 words that your ideal client would use when searching for the service you offer.
- Use these keywords throughout your profile in as many sections as possible, including your: Headline, Role descriptions, Skills, and endorsements.

Banner

- Having a LinkedIn banner, also known as a LinkedIn cover photo, is essential as it can enhance your LinkedIn profile.
- A customized banner shows that you care about your professional image and take your LinkedIn profile seriously.
- If you are associated with a company or personal brand, you can use the banner to reinforce that branding and make it consistent with your other online presence.

About

- Write a compelling and concise summary that captures your professional story and career goals.
- Use this section to showcase your unique value proposition and what sets you apart from others in your field.
- Include relevant keywords to improve your profile's visibility in LinkedIn searches.

Education

- Include all your relevant educational information, such as degrees, certifications, and coursework.
- Mention any academic honours, awards, or achievements.
- Add a description of your educational experiences, highlighting their relevance to your professional goals.
- Connect with alumni from your educational institutions to expand your network and gain potential opportunities.

Skills

- Select skills that are relevant to your profession and align with your career objectives.
- Seek endorsements from colleagues and connections to validate your skills.
- Too many unrelated skills may be distracting on your profile.

Experience & Accomplishments

- Include keywords relevant to your industry
- Showcase the progression of your career by listing experiences in reverse chronological order
- Utilize this section to showcase awards, honours, publications, or patents you have received
- Include details about any speaking engagements, conferences, or events you have participated in.
- Highlight projects you've worked on that demonstrate your skills and expertise.

Recommendations

- Request recommendations from colleagues, supervisors, or clients who can speak to your strengths and work ethic.
- Aim for a diverse range of recommendations that cover different aspects of your professional abilities.

Volunteering

- The volunteering experiences you mention on your profile almost play the same role as your work experiences
- Showcase any leadership positions or projects you managed while volunteering.

Customized URL

- Create a custom URL for your LinkedIn profile (e.g., www.linkedin.com/in/yourname) to make it easy to share and promote.
- A customized URL looks more professional and is easier for the network to remember.
- Here are some tutorials on how you can update your URL:
  Via Desktop
  Via Mobile App

Account Types

Personal Accounts

- Personal accounts are for individual professionals looking to showcase their skills, work experience, and professional achievements
- Your personal profile includes your profile picture, summary, work experience, education, skills, recommendations, and more
- On having a personal account, you can connect with other professionals, join LinkedIn groups, follow companies and influencers, and engage with content through likes, comments, and shares
- Personal accounts are available in both free and premium versions.

Company Pages

- Company pages are simply dedicated profiles for businesses, organizations, and brands
- Having a company page allows you to share information about your products, services, company culture, and job openings
- Here you can post updates, articles, and videos to engage with your followers and potential customers
- Usually, LinkedIn members follow company pages to stay updated with their latest news and developments
- LinkedIn also offers analytics for company pages, allowing your business to track the performance and engagement of your content.

LinkedIn Creator Mode

- LinkedIn Creator Mode is a feature introduced by LinkedIn to empower content creators and influencers to enhance their personal brand and engage with their audience more effectively.



- It provides users with additional tools and options to showcase their expertise,
- grow their following, and foster meaningful connections within the LinkedIn community
- However, you need to activate this mode on your account to access its features. Once you're done with this, your profile layout is optimized to showcase your content more prominently.

Below are some of the key features that come when you enable this mode:

Profile Header: The profile header is updated to highlight your chosen topic of expertise, making it clear to visitors what kind of content they can expect from you as a creator.
Featured Content: Creators can select specific posts and articles they want to showcase more prominently on their profile, allowing visitors to get a quick glimpse of their most relevant and popular content.
Follow Button: The "Connect" button on the profile is replaced with a "Follow" button, encouraging users to follow the updates without needing to send a connection request.
Activity Section: The activity section on the profile displays your recent posts and engagement metrics (only to you), providing visitors with a snapshot of their recent content contributions and their impact.
Custom Creator Badge: When you enable Creator Mode, a custom "Creator" badge is displayed on the your profile picture, signifying your active role in producing content.
Insights and Analytics: LinkedIn also provides you with additional insights and analytics regarding the performance of your posts and content reach.

Conclusion

In this document, we looked at all the features available on LinkedIn and how you can use them to enhance your profile.

The above information is based on LinkedIn's UI which might change in the future. Refer to the LinkedIn Updates Page to stay updated with current trends.

Keep Creating!